

Nathan A. Kowalski

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 8+ years of experience building distributed systems and cloud-native applications at scale. Proven track record of leading platform migrations, reducing infrastructure costs, and mentoring engineering teams. Passionate about developer experience and high-availability architecture.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — Platform

Mar 2022 – Present

Amazon Web Services · Seattle, WA

- Lead a team of 6 engineers building internal developer platform tooling serving 4,000+ AWS engineers.
- Redesigned container orchestration layer using Kubernetes and Helm, reducing deploy times by 62%.
- Drove adoption of gRPC-based service mesh replacing legacy REST adapters; cut p99 latency from 320ms to 48ms.
- Authored RFC and implemented blue/green deployment framework now used across 14 service teams.

Software Engineer II

Aug 2019 – Feb 2022

Stripe · San Francisco, CA (Remote)

- Built and maintained core payment processing pipelines in Go handling \$2B+ in annual transaction volume.
- Implemented idempotency key system that reduced duplicate charges by 99.97% across all API endpoints.
- Collaborated with security team to harden webhook delivery with HMAC signing and replay protection.
- Contributed to internal observability tooling: distributed tracing with OpenTelemetry, custom Grafana dashboards.

Software Engineer

Jun 2017 – Jul 2019

Clearbit (YC S15) · San Francisco, CA

- Designed and shipped RESTful enrichment API serving 50M+ requests/month for B2B SaaS customers.
- Migrated monolithic Rails app to microservices architecture; improved deployment frequency from weekly to daily.
- Built data ingestion pipeline (Python/Kafka) processing 10M company records from 200+ third-party sources.

Junior Software Engineer

Jan 2016 – May 2017

Whitepages Inc. · Seattle, WA

- Developed search and ranking algorithms for people-search product with 30M monthly active users.
- Maintained Python/Django backend services and wrote unit/integration test suites (pytest, 85% coverage).

SKILLS

Languages

Python Go TypeScript SQL Bash

Infrastructure

Kubernetes Terraform AWS Docker

Helm

Data / Messaging

PostgreSQL Redis Kafka gRPC

Practices

CI/CD TDD Observability Agile

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science

University of Washington

2015 · GPA 3.8 · Dean's List

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023)

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, 2022)

Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (2021)

LANGUAGES

English — Native

Polish — Conversational